



Nautilus

You might spot this stripy surprise jetting through the ocean. The nautilus (nor-ti-luss) is a distant cousin of octopuses; however, it lives inside a beautiful shell. Poking out are up to 90 spaghetti-like tentacles that the nautilus uses to grab its favourite foods: prawns and crabs. A nautilus uses energy up very slowly, so it only needs to eat once a month.

Like a submarine, the nautilus rises and sinks by letting gas and water in and out of chambers in its shell. It moves by squirting sea water from a special tube near its mouth, making it rock gently back and forth. It usually travels backwards, shell first, so it can't see where it's going!

